

ACH — Unit Economics

The cheapest rail — already efficient

FULLY-LOADED COST PER TRANSACTION

\$0.395

Costs \$0.38 MORE per txn if migrated (do not migrate)

Cost component	Detail	Amount	% of total
1. Network fee		\$0.005	1.3%
2. Processing / operations		\$0.150	38.0%
3. Failure & exception	1.5% return × \$4.00/item	\$0.060	15.2%
4. Fraud loss (expected)		\$0.050	12.7%
5. Fraud prevention / screening		\$0.050	12.7%
6. Compliance (AML / sanctions)		\$0.030	7.6%
7. Reconciliation		\$0.050	12.7%
8. Liquidity / prefunding		\$0.000	0.0%
TOTAL		\$0.395	100.0%

Cost composition (share of the fully-loaded cost)



What this means: Standard ACH is already the cheapest rail at ~\$0.40. Because that is **below** instant's full cost (~\$0.77), migrating ACH to instant would **cost more, not less**. Leave ACH where it is.

Sources: Network fees — Fed / Nacha / The Clearing House pricing. Failure rates — Nacha return thresholds (~1.5% typical); failed-payment cost ~\$12.10 (LexisNexis). Fraud — AFP Payments Fraud Survey; 2024 losses check ~\$24B, ACH ~\$11B, APP ~\$12.5B. Compliance — FFIEC / BSA-AML. Liquidity — RTP prefunded joint account (frbervices.org). All figures are conservative public-benchmark midpoints, to be calibrated with Payfinia production data. See Deliverable 1.